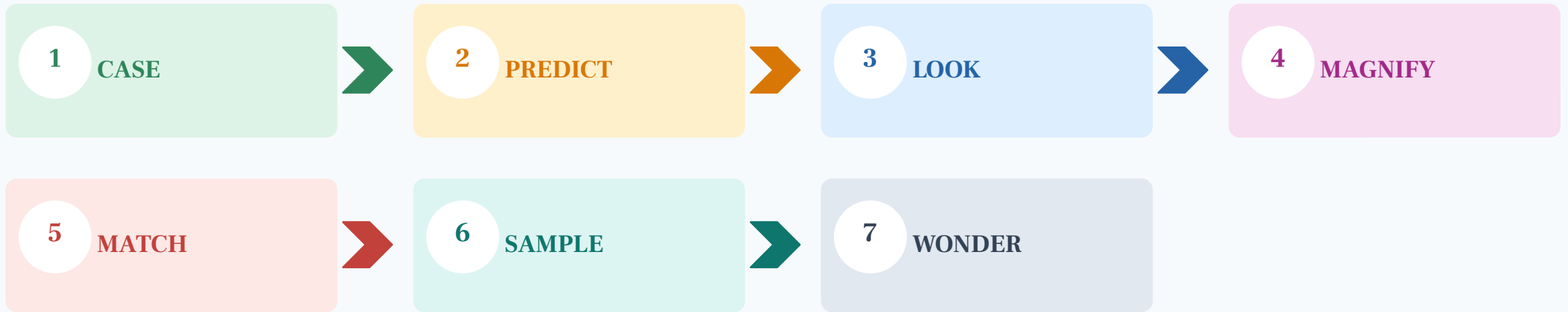


Researchers, come investigate!

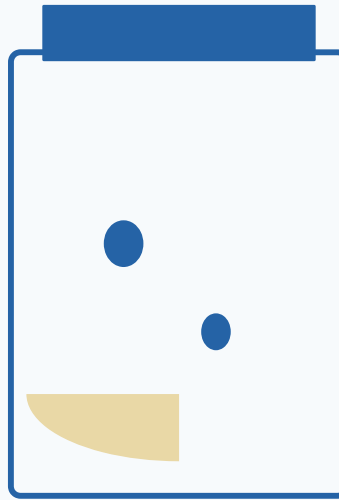
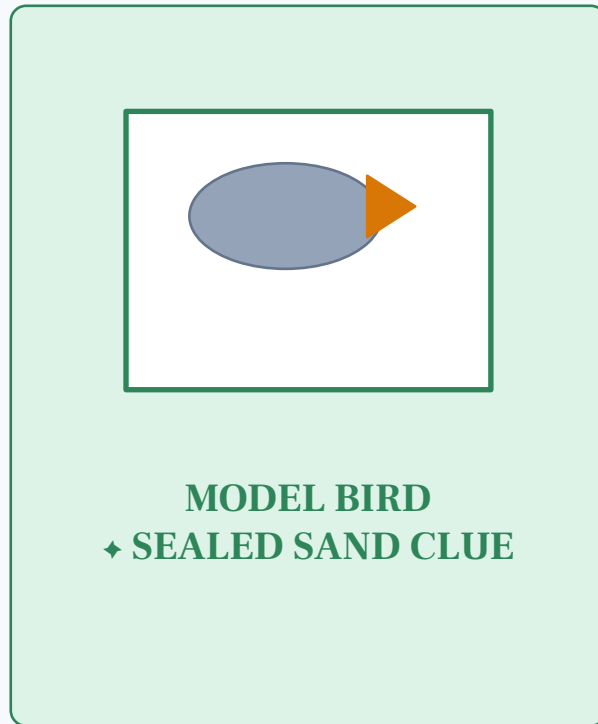
We will solve a model sand case, collect real evidence, and leave one question for camp.



Choose a route: point, draw, speak, write, photograph, work with a partner, ask us to write, or pass and join later.

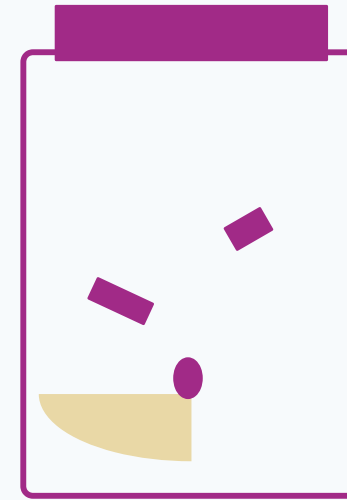
The fictional case

A model mystery gives us a known answer. Real beach evidence will stay open until we investigate it.



Durand reference

OR



Ontario reference

Which reference sample best matches the clue?

EVIDENCE LIMIT: This is a fictional model case. It does not report a real injured bird, prove why an animal needed care, or confirm that a visible fragment is plastic.

Before → During → After

The goal is not a perfect first guess. The goal is to notice, compare, and revise with evidence.

BEFORE

- 1 Predict what you will notice first.
- 2 Circle your confidence.
- 3 Say, draw, point, or ask for a scribe.



DURING

- 1 Look without magnification.
- 2 Count visible proxy pieces.
- 3 Magnify and record what changes.



AFTER

- 1 Compare both site records.
- 2 Match the mystery clue.
- 3 Revise your claim and name a limit.

Compare the evidence

A match should use more than one feature. Keep the observations separate from the conclusion.

FEATURE	DURAND	ONTARIO	MYSTERY CLUE
Grain color	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>
Grain size	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>
Visible proxy count	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>
Magnified proxy count	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>
Other pattern	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>	<i>record</i>

Claim = best match. Evidence = the features that support it. Limit = what the model cannot tell us.

Use evidence language

The three sentence starters keep observation, inference, and uncertainty from blending together.

I NOTICED ...

What I saw, counted, or measured.

I THINK ...

My explanation or best match.

WE STILL NEED ...

Evidence that could confirm or challenge the claim.

A visually suspected fiber or fragment is not chemically confirmed plastic. Careful uncertainty is part of good science.

Collect a real sand sample

Every pair uses the same method so our samples remain traceable and comparable.



CHOOSE

Choose and name the site.



FRAME

Place the red square.



SCOOP

Collect the top 1/2 inch.



SEAL

Close the jar before moving.



LABEL

Pair + site + time.



MAP

Draw or mark the location.

STOP: Do not add salt water at the beach. Keep every field sample sealed and separate. We will process each sample in its own labeled container.

Choose your science role

Roles can change. No role owns the science, and every role can add evidence.

OBSERVER

SAMPLER

LABELER

MAPPER

PHOTOGRAPHER

RECORDER

MATERIALS MONITOR

SEATED COORDINATOR

You may look, point, draw, speak, write, photograph, dictate, use home language, work with a partner, choose a low-energy role, or pass and re-enter.

Our goal is the same: observe, compare, name uncertainty, and ask a useful question.

Leave one question

Friday opens the mystery. Camp week adds evidence and revises the model.

ANCHOR

Humans aren't trash cans, but we have plastics in our bodies.

DRIVING QUESTION

How does plastic break into tiny pieces, move through the environment and into living bodies, and how can we stop it fairly?

Choose one question to leave for Monday:

-  What might a first look miss?
-  How could plastic move through connected systems?
-  What evidence would confirm a suspected particle?
-  Where could a fair change interrupt the pathway?

MONDAY PREVIEW

**BRINE → SETTLE → TRANSFER
→ FILTER → DRY → INSPECT**

Suspected is not the same as confirmed.